

Barnsley FC Fan Advisory Group Meeting Minutes

Date of Meeting	Tuesday 11 th February 2025
Location	Rimmington Lounge, Oakwell Stadium
Time	6:30 pm
Meeting Objective(s)	

Attendance

Present		Apologies	
Mladen Sormaz - MS	Andy Gaskill – AG	Phil Hall	
Jon Flatman - JF	Robin Harris – RH	Heather Linney	
Dave Watson – DW	Curtis Ledger – CL	Dominic Wood	
Kieron Campbell - KC	Martin Wilson – MW		
Clare Calton – CC	Steve Brain – SB		
Kelly Drury – KD			
Paul Gallagher - PG			

Agenda, Discussions, Issues

Topic / Discussion Notes	Discussion led by
Agenda Item 1 - January Transfer Window Whilst it was recognised that inviting MS to the FAB meeting was an unusual request, it is to the Club's and MS's credit that they facilitated that opportunity. The overwhelming concern of Barnsley Fans at the end of the January transfer window was to look for some sort of explanation as to what the Club's approach and thinking was during the month. The FAB exists to represent fellow supporters and it was felt that we would have been doing our fellow supporters a disservice to not at least try and broker a meeting and engage with the Club. The output from this meeting is detailed below.	
The meeting was a two-way dialogue, with questions and answers throughout. Mladen gave an initial overview of the process, after which queries were raised by the FAB members, to establish the following: • There are a number of individuals involved in the recruitment process at the club: The Board, The Head Coach and the Recruitment Team. • It is not just data driven recruitment; players are watched both internally and external to the club. • This is how a vast majority of the clubs operate from mid Championship to League two clubs. • Once the January transfer window closes, the club begin to review the team's current situation, identify the team's needs in more detail, narrowing this down and being more specific, and then start to identify any potential targets from other clubs. • In recent years we have lost the services of Herbie Kane and Devante Cole, and therefore, the focus was for players that were ready to start. • This monitoring continues throughout the season for players both internal and external to the club. • Prior to the summer, a list of desirable players to approach is formulated over the summer months. This is then presented to the Stakeholders. • These players are then ranked, identifying the Club's needs and expectations. The ranking includes where the potential player is currently, their projected ability and their possible progression within a team. • Finances are then discussed with the Board regarding the spending budget for the future plans and squad. This could be made up of a number of elements, including spending per player, how likely is the deal likely to	

come to fruition and what is the timeline available for players and the clubs involved.

- Clubs have different agendas and sometimes this is also a factor in the sale or availability of that Club's under contract players, and their anticipated value and what realistic offers could be made.
- Throughout the summer, from May onwards, the Recruitment Team review the list systematically as the target players also have options and choices to make. It is not only Barnsley FC in the market looking to buy and sign players.
- The Club may also work and negotiate with a player over a longer period of time, considering the longer term prospects for the club.
- This becomes a balancing act, as we are usually in competition with other teams for a small pool of players.
- Some markets have now been eliminated due to changes in the law for European clubs regarding the signing and transferring of players. This has had the effect of making the pool for quality players smaller and smaller.
- We make sure that each position on the field has a potential of 5 players who are identified as above average, and then a further 5 who could also deliver what we require.
- All our future targets need to be treated with the strictest confidence, as this could alert other clubs to our interest and jeopardize the potential opportunity for the transfer to be successful; meaning the best price, circumstances and conditions for the club.
- The longer term sustainability for the club is also vital. These considerations include our current players, loan deals in and out of the club, and also balancing players' requests and desires to ensure both parties remain happy.
- Loaning out our players also gives the club an opportunity to assist that player, to determine whether they (our own younger players) are developing as we would hope.
- Loaning in players gives us the chance to assess a player's future potential and helps us make a judgement on whether we could look at purchasing at a future date,
- Our Recruitment Team is well networked and they continuously feed into all the above areas.
- There is discussion with the Board regarding costs. This incorporates fees paid, wages and any potential value that may be interpreted as an "off set" of the player's costs. This is a balance between medium and longer term, to ensure risk is calculated and then managed. The Football Club must adhere to a number of regulatory bodies in order to continue to operate.
- Players are not just identified on data. The process may start with data and a player may look impressive re his starts and goals ratio for instance. Other factors are also analysed, such as his stature, and the league the data is formulated from. We also undertake observations of players in person through our scouting network, or through recordings and/or media.
- This is no rule regarding signing under 23s. Signing players, depends on the need, availability, current market value and the other factors already touched upon.
- JF referenced the Salary Cost Management Protocol (SCMP) changes for next season, which were only voted on by clubs in December; which will now only allow a percentage of equity funding by Owners to count as income, compared to the current 100% allowance. This will require Owners (generally, not just BFC) to invest more funds than they are allowed to use for operating purposes under the SCMP rules. Potentially, this incentivised

other clubs to invest more heavily in January ahead of these rules coming in.			
Barnsley FC Community Trust and FAB			
As a separate item, Dave Watson and Kieron Campbell from the BFC Community Trust updated the FAB on the work they undertake in the Community.			
It was agreed that the FAB and the BFCCT will strengthen their links and work together at every opportunity.			
Close – 20.10pm			
Action Items			
Action Log		Responsible	Due Date
Next Meeting			
Date:	Tues 18.03.25	Time:	6.30 pm
		Location:	F2F @ OAKWELL Online Available